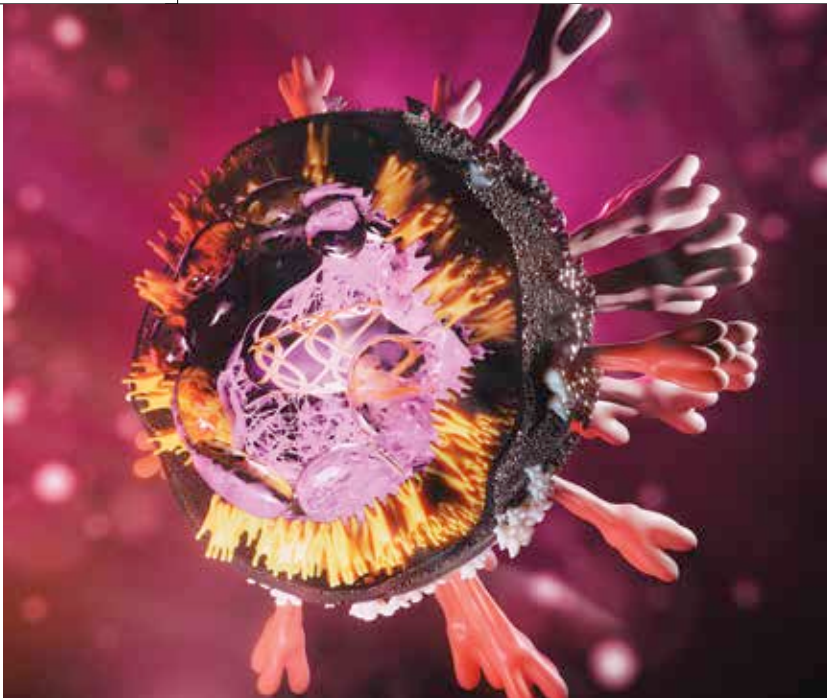




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OMICRON VARIANT EXPLAINED

SARS-CoV-2:
Changing variants,
wreaking lives

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After 2020, everyone took a much-needed breather, but what 2021 brought along in the form of the second wave of Coronavirus infections globally, made everyone run straight back into their homes, while sending the medical system into chaos. When everyone thought that the second wave was over, the virus

pulled another card out of its sleeve and presented us with its mutated forms, of which the Omicron variant is the newest and fastest to spread.

After being a central figure in many conversations, and infecting people worldwide, the SARS-CoV-2 variant: B.1.1.529, popularly known



Omicron is the latest from among many variants of the Covid-19 virus

as Omicron, has been labelled a variant of concern. This has raised many eyebrows because the already active variants of the virus have been wreaking havoc, and no one knows what this has in store for us. For the most part.

Before we delve into the details, here's a brief about how the Omicron variant came to be. According to the UNICEF web page dedicated to this variant of the virus, "When a virus is circulating widely and causing numerous infections, the likelihood of the virus mutating increases. The more opportunities a virus has to spread, the more opportunities it has to undergo changes."

As the world governments and administrative bodies prepare, in the wake of the increasing cases being triggered by the Omicron variant, it is important that you also stay informed. So, here we have brought for you a brief guide that will help you know the latest iteration of the Coronavirus better so that you can give better information to the ones in contact with you, making them and yourself better prepared to fight the looming third wave, which we pray never comes.

WHAT DO WE KNOW?

When the first cases of this new variant were reported, no one knew what this exactly was. But since then, efforts of virologists and related researchers worldwide, day in and day out, have brought in some helpful information. One of the firsts in this very brief list is that the variant itself has a lot of variations. This means that this variant of the virus can take different forms and cause infections of varying nature, making it harder to identify and track. Reportedly, this variant hasn't evolved from any other variant of note but has branched out distinctly, with its evolution starting around the second half of 2020.

The second that we know about the nature of the Omicron variant is that it is less harmful or, to say, severe in terms of causing infections when